

Question:

A 67-year-old man is brought to the emergency room after being involved in a traffic accident. He currently complains of bilateral hip pain. His vital signs are within the normal range, and he is hemodynamically stable. The pelvic compression test is positive. External genitalia appears normal, except there is blood at the urethral meatus and a contusion at the base of the scrotum. Digital rectal examination (DRE) shows a high-riding ballotable prostate. An X-ray reveals the presence of a pelvic fracture. Which of the following initial actions is the most appropriate for this patient? Answer Choices: A. Obtain a retrograde urethrogram (RUG), including a pre-injection kidney, ureter, and bladder (KUB) film B. Insert a Foley catheter C. Perform a suprapubic cystostomy D. Take the patient emergently to the operating room and check for a urethral injury with IV indigo carmine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient is involved in a traffic accident and has pelvic fractures. The pelvic compression test is positive, and the digital rectal examination (DRE) shows a high - riding, ballotable prostate, which is a sign of a possible urethral injury, as the prostate is displaced due to the injury. Blood at the urethral meatus and a contusion at the base of the scrotum also support the possibility of urethral trauma. The presence of blood and the contusion at the urethral meatus are strong indicators of a urethral injury. Inserting a Foley catheter (B) is the most appropriate initial action to relieve urinary retention, manage hematuria, and check for urethral injury. A retrograde urethrogram (RUG) (A) is a diagnostic test that can be performed later to confirm the nature of the urethral injury. Suprapubic cystostomy (C) is a more invasive procedure used in cases of severe urinary retention that can't be managed with a Foley catheter. Taking the patient to the operating room for immediate evaluation of the urethra with IV indigo carmine (D) is not the initial action and is more of a surgical decision to be made after a preliminary examination and assessment. </think> <answer> B . Insert a Foley catheter </answer>

